

CirqlCade Feel-Tuning Pass — Plan

The Linear project mirrored to print. All 50 games are built, live, and mechanically verified — but none are feel-tuned yet. This plan captures owner + tester feel notes per game and turns them into engine-constant changes. Project: [CirqlCade Feel-Tuning Pass](#) · issues **CHR-130 ... CHR-179** (one per game) · worksheet: [docs/cirql/CirqlCade-Playtest-Notes.pdf](#) .

Workflow:

- Play a game → open its issue → fill the scorecard (Fun / Controls / Speed / Difficulty / Readability / Juice / Length + Verdict).
 - Jot **+** **Add** (missing), **−** **Cut** (annoying), **🔪** **Feel** (speed/weight/timing/sound/colour/spikes).
 - Move the issue Todo → In Review when scored. I map each **🔪** Feel note to a **Knob** → tuning commit; queue **REWORK** games as tasks; action **CUT** calls; then Done.
- Verdicts:** **KEEP** ship as-is · **TUNE** number tweaks · **REWORK** right idea wrong execution · **CUT** drop it. **Knob** = a constant I can turn without a redesign (a Feel note that maps to one is a same-day change).

Priority order (deepest first — highest leverage)

★ **Beat** (CHR-130, audio-sync) · **Survivor** (CHR-131, needs an upgrade-choice decision) · **Coil** (CHR-132) · **Keep** (CHR-133) · **Command** (CHR-134) · **Dodge** (CHR-135) — then flagship trio Bounce/Defender/Pop (CHR-136/137/138), then the rest.

All 50 issues

Issue	Game	Genre	Prio	Watch for	Knobs I can tune
CHR-130	★ Cirql Beat	Rhythm	High	★ the standout to polish — audio-visual sync (critical!), timing-window fairness, tempo ramp, is the beat actually musical.	Hit-window tolerance, note speed & tempo climb, groove drain/gain, note density, track/BPM.
CHR-131	★ Cirql Survivor	Roguelite	High	★ the deepest one — auto-upgrade has NO choice UI (flag if you want to pick upgrades); XP/level pace; swarm scaling; run length; power fantasy. Likely REWORK: add an upgrade-choice screen on level-up.	XP curve, upgrade values (fire rate/shots/damage), enemy spawn & scaling, pickup radius, move speed.
CHR-132	★ Cirql Coil	Zuma	High	★ aiming precision, chain-speed pressure, is the match-3 burst satisfying, does insertion feel right.	Chain advance speed, colour count, fire speed, match-burst chaining, spawn rate, core distance.
CHR-133	★ Cirql Keep	Tower defense	High	★ economy balance (can you afford defense?), turret placement clarity, wave pressure, is it too easy/hard.	Turret cost/damage/range, enemy HP & wave scaling, income rate, path length, core HP.
CHR-134	★ Cirql Command	Galcon	High	★ RTS — the AI is simple (flag if too easy/dumb), fleet-send feel, match length, is a comeback possible.	Production rate, fleet speed, AI aggression/smarts, node count/layout, starting balance.
CHR-135	★ Cirql Dodge	Bullet-hell	High	★ deep one — hitbox fairness (is the hitbox small?), pattern readability, does drag feel precise, difficulty ramp.	Bullet speed & density, pattern variety, hitbox size, spawn ramp, player speed.
CHR-136	Cirql Bounce	Breakout	Med	Dial responsiveness at speed; ball never gets stuck in a boring loop; boss phase is a spike not a wall; reward-bridge perks feel earned.	Ball speed & speed-up rate, dial sensitivity, brick HP/rows, boss HP & timer, Pulse/Nova cooldowns.
CHR-137	Cirql Defender	Missile Command	Med	Shield arc width (can you actually catch things?); enemy fall speed vs dial speed; is deflect-chain satisfying; boss-every-5th readable.	Shield arc width, enemy speed & spawn rate, wave scaling, Fire range/rate, Pulse cooldown, core HP.
CHR-138	Cirql Pop	Bubble shooter	Med	Ring rotation speed (aiming fair?); add-row interval (pressure right?); lose-ring distance; is Swap useful.	Ring rotation speed, add-row interval, colour count, lose-ring threshold, bubble speed.
CHR-139	Cirql Spin	Tetris	—	Fall speed vs how fast you can aim+flip; ring-clear feels good; overflow (lose) is fair; column readability.	Fall speed & ramp, piece variety, ring size, max-ring lose height, drop lock delay.
CHR-140	Cirql Snake	Snake	—	Lane-hop feel (snappy? mushy?); angular speed; self-collision fairness (gap tolerance); boost usefulness/cooldown.	Angular speed & growth-per-orb, lane count, boost power & cooldown, self-collision gap, orb spawn rate.

Issue	Game	Genre	Prio	Watch for	Knobs I can tune
CHR-141	Cirql Bloom	Zen garden	—	Is it genuinely calming; sweep responsiveness; grow cost curve (rewarding, not grindy); does Finish feel right.	Mote drift speed & density, energy-per-gather, grow cost curve, petal visuals, palette.
CHR-142	Cirql Reactor	Simon	—	Playback speed (too fast to memorize?); tap targets big enough; clear win/lose feedback; how long before it gets hard.	Playback speed, segment count, +N growth per round, input timeout, tone pitches.
CHR-143	Cirql Chain	Chain reaction	—	Is the cascade satisfying to watch; does one tap feel impactful; clear target fair; downtime between rounds.	Node density & speed, blast radius, chain threshold per round, cascade timing/visuals.
CHR-144	Cirql Shift	Color Switch	—	Timing window fairness; gate approach speed; colour readability (colourblind?); frustration spikes.	Approach speed & ramp, colour count, gate spacing, switch responsiveness.
CHR-145	Cirql Dash	Frogger	—	Gap timing readability; ring speeds fair; is progress toward centre satisfying; death feels earned not random.	Ring rotation speeds & directions, gap size, ring count, hop cooldown, hazard density.
CHR-146	Cirql Runner	Endless runner	—	Jump feel (float/weight); obstacle telegraphing; speed ramp fair; does it get impossible too fast.	Run speed & ramp rate, jump height/gravity, obstacle spacing & mix, spawn randomness.
CHR-147	Cirql Invaders	Space Invaders	—	Fire rate vs enemy speed; wave descent pressure; aiming precision with the dial; clear feels achievable.	Enemy speed & descent rate, fire rate, wave size/formation, enemy fire frequency.
CHR-148	Cirql Tunnel	Tempest	—	Lane readability (depth perception); movement snappiness; enemy surface speed; overwhelm point.	Enemy climb speed, lane count, fire rate, spawn rate, zap/super cooldown.
CHR-149	Cirql Maze	Brain game	—	Puzzle clarity (can you see the gaps?); rotation feel; timer pressure fair; satisfying drop.	Ring count, gap alignment difficulty, timer length, rotation snap, orb drop speed.
CHR-150	Cirql Link	Flow	—	Drag accuracy; puzzle always solvable & feels so; is it actually relaxing; timer needed or not.	Grid size, node-pair count, timer (or remove), path-draw forgiveness, palette.
CHR-151	Cirql Orbit	Asteroids	—	Physics feel (drifty vs tight); black-hole danger readable; is scooping rewarding; motion sickness.	Thrust power, drag/inertia, gravity-well strength, energy spawn, hazard count.
CHR-152	Cirql Pinball	Pinball	—	Flipper timing/power; ball physics fun; drain fair; enough targets/scoring interest.	Flipper power & size, gravity, ball speed, bumper count & payout, drain gap.
CHR-153	Cirql Race	Slot-car	—	AI competitiveness (winnable but not trivial); boost timing matters; lane-change feel; race length.	AI speed & aggression, boost power/cooldown, lap count, lane-change speed, corner physics.
CHR-154	Cirql Miner	Dig Dug	—	Monster AI (fair chase?); movement responsiveness; gem layout interesting; tension level.	Player & monster speed, monster count/AI, gem density, level clear target.
CHR-155	Cirql Claim	Qix	—	Is wedge-tap satisfying (note: not true area-fill — flag if it feels thin); spark threat fair; % target good.	Wedge size, spark speed & count, claim % target, claim animation speed.
CHR-156	Cirql Pong	Pong	—	AI beatable but not trivial; paddle speed keeps up with ball; ball speed-up fair; rallies fun.	AI reaction speed, ball speed & speed-up, paddle size/speed, lives.
CHR-157	Cirql Whack	Whack-a-mole	—	Pop rate (enough action?); bomb penalty fair; 30s the right length; tap hit-targets forgiving.	Pop rate & lifetime, bomb frequency & penalty, timer length, target size, score curve.
CHR-158	Cirql Reflex	Reaction	—	Flare is unmistakable; false-start rule feels fair; 5 rounds right; result/score meaningful.	Wait-time randomness range, false-start penalty, round count, flare visuals.
CHR-159	Cirql Pairs	Memory	—	Card count right; flip animation speed; timer pressure fair; symbols distinct.	Pair count, timer length, flip/peek speed, symbol set, mismatch delay.
CHR-160	Cirql Flip	Lights-Out	—	Puzzle solvable & feels fair; tap targets clear; timer needed?; win is satisfying.	Segment count, scramble depth, timer (or remove), flip animation, neighbour rule.
CHR-161	Cirql Stack	Stacker	—	Sweep speed vs reaction; overlap-trim tension; ramp fair; near-top nail-biter feel.	Sweep speed & ramp, starting arc width, trim strictness, rings-to-win.

Issue	Game	Genre	Prio	Watch for	Knobs I can tune
CHR-162	Cirql Gems	Match-3	—	Swap feel; cascade payoff; board never dead-locks; is there a goal/timer or endless.	Gem colour count, board size, cascade scoring, refill speed, move limit/timer.
CHR-163	Cirql Sweep	Minesweeper	—	Flag/dig toggle intuitive; numbers legible on wedges; 3 lives right; first-tap safe.	Grid size, mine density, lives, first-click safety radius, number colours.
CHR-164	Cirql Sort	Ball sort	—	Always solvable & feels so; pour animation speed; tube count right; undo needed?	Colour count, tube count, balls-per-tube, pour speed, add undo?
CHR-165	Cirql Merge	2048	—	Does the spin mechanic click (or confuse?); merge feel; soft-lock never happens; high-value payoff.	Ring size, spawn value distribution, merge scoring, spin-vs-slide clarity, target tile.
CHR-166	Cirql Drop	Plinko	—	Aim matters (not pure luck?); bounce physics satisfying; 8 balls right; scoring zones clear.	Peg layout & bounciness, ball count, gravity, scoring zones, aim range.
CHR-167	Cirql Ascent	Doodle Jump	—	Steer feel (tilt vs tap?); platform spacing fair; fall death fair; how high feels good.	Bounce height/gravity, platform spacing & movement, scroll speed, steer sensitivity.
CHR-168	Cirql Balance	Balance	—	Control sensitivity (tippy vs sluggish); gust escalation fair; tension satisfying; run length.	Nudge force, gravity/instability, gust frequency & strength, balance tolerance.
CHR-169	Cirql Breathe	Calm	—	Pacing genuinely calming; ring expand/contract smooth; session length; audio/visual soothing.	Breath cycle timing (in/hold/out), visual smoothness, colours, optional sound.
CHR-170	Cirql Lander	Lunar Lander	—	Thrust/gravity balance; landing tolerance (too strict/loose?); control scheme intuitive; fuel tension.	Gravity, thrust power, safe-landing speed threshold, pad size, fuel amount.
CHR-171	Cirql Slice	Fruit Ninja	—	Swipe detection crisp; orb spawn rate; bomb fair; slash juice satisfying.	Orb spawn rate & speed, bomb frequency, timer, swipe hit-width, combo scoring.
CHR-172	Cirql Osmos	Agar	—	Propulsion feel (eject-to-move?); growth pace; threat readability (who's bigger); drift control fun or annoying.	Propulsion force, mote size distribution & count, growth rate, drift/drag.
CHR-173	Cirql Crawler	Centipede	—	Split mechanic satisfying; crawler speed vs fire rate; aiming precision; overwhelm point.	Crawler speed & length, fire rate, split behaviour, spawn rate, lives.
CHR-174	Cirql Spiro	Zen draw	—	Is it mesmerizing; drag→shape responsiveness; colours beautiful; when to Finish clear.	Draw speed, gear ratio range, line colours/glow, trail persistence.
CHR-175	Cirql Tide	Zen sandbox	—	Particle response satisfying; genuinely relaxing; performance (lots of particles) smooth on phone; visual payoff.	Particle count, sweep force & falloff, current decay, glow/colours.
CHR-176	Cirql Gunner	Twin-stick	—	Aim control tight; swarm pressure fair; fire feel punchy; overwhelm curve.	Enemy spawn rate & speed, fire rate & damage, aim sensitivity, enemy HP.
CHR-177	Cirql Tap	osu!	—	Timing window fair; ring-close visual clear; dot spawn pace; combo satisfying; audio sync.	Hit-window, ring-close speed, spawn rate & pattern, combo scoring.
CHR-178	Cirql Sumo	Ring-out	—	Knockback physics satisfying; AI competitiveness; dash cooldown/feel; ring-out threshold fair.	Dash force & cooldown, knockback strength, friction, AI aggression, ring size.
CHR-179	Cirql Weave	Zen draw	—	Distinct enough from Spiro?; tuning intuitive; figures beautiful; relaxing.	Pendulum frequency/decay ranges, line colours/glow, draw speed, trail length.